

ANGEL ACTION · BURNS

Burns and Scalds

Cool any burn under cool running water for at least 20 minutes, remove clothing and jewellery from the area unless stuck, and cover loosely with cling wrap or a sterile non-stick dressing.

Treat every burn the same way first

1. **Stop the burning.** Move away from the heat source. For clothing on fire: stop, drop, cover, roll.
2. Follow **DRSABCD** if the person is seriously unwell.
3. **Cool the burn** under **cool running water for at least 20 minutes**. This works for up to 3 hours after the burn.
4. Remove tight clothing and jewellery from the area — leave anything stuck to the skin.
5. Cover loosely with a **sterile non-stick dressing** or **cling wrap** laid flat (not wrapped tightly around a limb).
6. Treat for **shock** if the burn is large.

When to call 000

- Burn is larger than a 20-cent coin.
- Burn to the face, hands, feet, genitals or over a joint.
- Burns to a child, elderly person, or anyone with another illness.
- Electrical or chemical burn.
- Inhalation burns (smoke, steam).

Do NOT

- Do **not** apply lotions, ointments, butter, toothpaste or ice.
- Do **not** burst blisters.
- Do **not** peel off stuck clothing.

Chemical burns

Brush off dry chemical first, then flood with cool running water for at least 20 minutes. Wear gloves to protect yourself.

Electrical burns

Turn off the power source first. The burn often looks small but causes deep internal damage — always seek medical assessment.

Adapted from Australian First Aid 5th Edition. Get the full guide and live CPR metronome at firstaidangel.org.